I remember us going close and me turning to Gary Neville:

‘They’re not that good, Gaz. We can win this, you know.’

Just a couple of minutes after that, I took a corner on the left and Roy Keane came in with a fantastic header to get it back to 2–1. You lose count of how many great games Keano has played for us. That night, though, was special even by his standards. He scored the goal and, soon afterwards, got a yellow card: he knew, and we all knew, that meant he was going to miss the final if we got there. But his head didn’t go down for an instant. All he cared about was winning that game for United. Who were we to argue? Who were Juventus to argue? As soon as we pulled one back, you could sense it turning. They started panicking all over the field. Yorkie equalized before half-time and then Andy Cole scored the winner about five minutes from the end.

It’s an ambition for any player to be involved in the biggest games for your club and your country. The European Cup Final, though: that was a mission at United. Every one of us knew that winning it was what the boss wanted more than anything else in soccer. When we came off at the end of the game in Turin 3–2 winners, we knew we were almost there. We had good enough players; it felt like luck, perhaps, was starting to run our way when we needed it to; and there was a spirit in that team, that season more than ever, which made us all feel like we couldn’t be beaten. Every game we played during the last couple of months of 1998/99 was a cup final in its way: if we’d lost any game, in the League, in the FA Cup or in Europe, it would have meant the Treble had gone. No-one knew if we’d ever be in the same kind of situation again and, so, none of us wanted to miss a single game of it, even though the manager kept coming up to us and saying he could rest us if we were feeling tired. We were on the kind of roll where you’d finish one game and the adrenaline kidded you into believing that you could play another one the following day, however heavy your legs were.

The Premiership title was between us and Arsenal, as close as the FA Cup semi-final had been, and they had their noses in front almost to the end. We had two games each left to play and, the night before we visited Blackburn, Arsenal were away to Leeds. For weeks we’d been waiting for them to slip up. I watched that game at Elland Road on television. The tension’s terrible: you can’t do anything about it, can you? Right at the end, Jimmy Floyd Hasselbaink scored and it felt like I had. We went up to Blackburn the next night and drew 0–0, which meant as long as we beat Spurs on the last day of the season, we’d be champions again. The Treble came down to ten days in May, starting at Old Trafford: our final Premiership game.